



Trump offers rare reproach of Putin

U.S. considers sanctions after one of biggest raids of war kills 12 in Ukraine

BY SIOBHÁN O'GRADY, SERHIY MORGUNOV AND ISOBEL KOSHIW

KYIV — President Donald Trump threatened new sanctions against Moscow on Sunday after Russia launched another massive missile and drone attack across Ukraine overnight, casting further doubt on Moscow's intentions in an already shaky peace process brokered by the Trump administration.

Trump had in recent days appeared to have abandoned the threat of harsh financial sanctions following a phone call with Russian President Vladimir Putin on May 19 in which he touted potential new trade deals with Russia. Trump's remarks following the attacks Sunday indicated a growing sense of frustration with his Russian counterpart.

"I'm not happy with what Putin is doing. He's killing a lot of people," Trump told reporters before boarding Air Force One on Sunday. "I don't know what the hell happened to Putin. I've known him a long time. Always gotten along with him, but he's sending rockets into cities and killing people, and I don't like it at all," he said.

Asked if he would consider more sanctions on Russia, the U.S. president said: "Absolutely."

The latest attack, which killed 12 people, according to authorities, lasted several hours and followed heavy bombardment the day before. It came as Russia and Ukraine proceeded with a days-long prisoner exchange the two sides agreed to during a rare summit in Istanbul this month.

SEE UKRAINE ON A10

Patients face new hurdles to affordable obesity drugs

BY DANIEL GILBERT

Laura Davisson is an obesity medicine doctor and professor at West Virginia University, but a growing part of her job is not something she trained for in medical school: looking for the best deal she can get for her patients.

"It's crazy," she said of the ever-changing insurance landscape for weight-loss medications. "It's absolutely insane to try to keep up with it all."

Across the country, doctors who treat patients for obesity are being forced to develop what amounts to a subspecialty in navigating health coverage for the most popular class of weight-loss medications, known as GLP-1 drugs. The spotty insurance coverage for obesity is dividing patients into classes of haves and have-nots as many insurers throttle back access.

With list prices in excess of \$1,000 a month, the cost of a single prescription is not extraordinary for health plans and employers, but the pressure of millions of patients seeking them is creating a major financial drain. So insurers are capping expenses by erecting a variety of hurdles before covering a

SEE INSURANCE ON A7

A soldier was recovering from head wounds suffered in Gaza. Then he died under close medical supervision. His mother is chasing the VA for answers — and coming up empty.



SAM WOLFE/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

'What happened to my baby?'

BY ALEX HORTON
IN MARION, S.C.

Just days before Sgt. Quandarius Stanley died in his Veterans Affairs hospital bed, his mother saw a glimmer of recovery.

The 23-year old soldier was struck by a forklift last May, resulting in devastating head injuries, while on the ill-fated U.S. mission to build a pier off Gaza for humanitarian aid delivery. He was left fighting for his life in an Israeli hospital, then transferred to Texas for months of intensive care — unable to move or speak.

In late October, a dental hygienist asked him to open his mouth for a quick look. He opened wide — the first time in five months he had responded to anyone, his mother Anna Stanley recalled.

The room erupted in applause. Anna was deep into planning for his discharge, and this small miracle filled her with hope. He would need lifelong care, but he would be home.

In the predawn morning of Oct. 31, VA hospital staff found Quandarius unresponsive.

Anna Stanley with a large photo of her son, Sgt. Quandarius Stanley, at her home on May 12. Quandarius died on Oct. 31, 2024, and an autopsy raised questions about his final moments.

His mother rushed to the lobby, still in her pajamas, and banged on the glass doors at the entrance, desperate to see her son.

He was already dead. "They dropped the ball," Anna said in an interview, with reams of VA records stacked on her coffee table detailing the death of her only child. "Everybody was shocked."

The private autopsy she requested would raise alarming questions about Quandarius's final moments. His blood showed "markedly elevated levels" of a medication used to treat his involuntary movements, and he probably died as a result of the toxicity, the report found. The autopsy also detected the presence of alcohol, a bewildering conclusion given his only way to ingest nutrients was through a feeding tube in his stomach.

His family has been left to confront these mysteries on the first anniversary of his injury off the Gaza coast, and the first Memorial Day at

SEE MEMORIAL ON A4

Finding comfort on the keys

The D.C. plane crash took her mother and sister. She took to her piano.

BY DANA MUNRO

Anne Valerie Ter sat on the short black bench in her piano teacher's basement, her mother's warm voice encouraging her as she draped her fingers over the keys to begin Rachmaninoff's Piano Concerto No. 2.

"Come on, you need to practice more," she heard her mother, Olesya Taylor, say.

The 14-year-old had spent the previous three months perfecting the piece — every dynamic, each delicate trill and sharp staccato. She planned on performing it at a concerto competition that was about two weeks away, where Taylor and Anne Valerie's younger sister, Olivia Ter, planned to be in the audience, proudly watching.

But they both existed only in her mind that January day.

Olesya Taylor was dead. So was Olivia, 12. Authorities had not confirmed it yet, but Anne Valerie knew in her gut that they had not survived the American Eagle Flight 5342 collision with a U.S. Army helicopter near Reagan National Airport the night before.

The symphony of her adolescence — chatty car rides with her mother, the blade on her sister's foot scraping against the ice as she landed a triple toe loop as a

SEE PIANIST ON A6



JOY SUNG/THE WASHINGTON POST

Anne Valerie Ter lost her mother, Olesya Taylor, and younger sister, Olivia Ter, in the crash near Reagan National Airport.

Tired of political attacks, Musk turns back to business

Billionaire plans to focus on the tech ventures that built his reputation

BY TRISHA THADANI
AND ELIZABETH DWOSKIN

About a year ago, Elon Musk quietly summoned a handful of Republican strategists and confidants to his sparsely decorated apartment overlooking downtown Austin. The Tesla CEO told the group that electing Donald Trump was essential to the country's future, and he was willing to do anything — and pay any amount — to create a "red wave" around the country.

He did a lot, launching the U.S. DOGE Service to orchestrate sweeping layoffs and budget cuts. He spent a lot, plowing at least \$288 million into the 2024 election. And last week, following a period of intense backlash against his political activity and his electric vehicle company, he seemed to draw a line under all that work: "I think I've done enough."

So what will be the next focus for the world's richest person?

Politics has been central to Musk's identity over much of the

past year, but his latest obsession has faded into disenchantment over the personal costs and difficulties in producing results, said two people familiar with his thinking in recent months, who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe private conversations. Musk has also become deeply concerned for the personal safety of himself and his family, the people said. He also did not anticipate the level of backlash against him personally or against his companies, including incidents of violence at Tesla facilities. Along with that push is a pull for renewed involvement in his two main businesses, Tesla and SpaceX.

Musk did not respond to a request for comment. He said during an interview at the Qatar Economic Forum that he would spend "a lot less" on campaigns unless he saw "a reason" to in the future. Privately, one of the people said, Musk is disillusioned with the impact his money can have in the political system and would rather spend his time and fortune elsewhere.

The billionaire said his attention is needed back at Tesla and

SEE MUSK ON A2

Grok Elon Musk's AI chatbot has parroted discredited claims. A11

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STYLE
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The Washington Post
Year 148, No. 54228

